



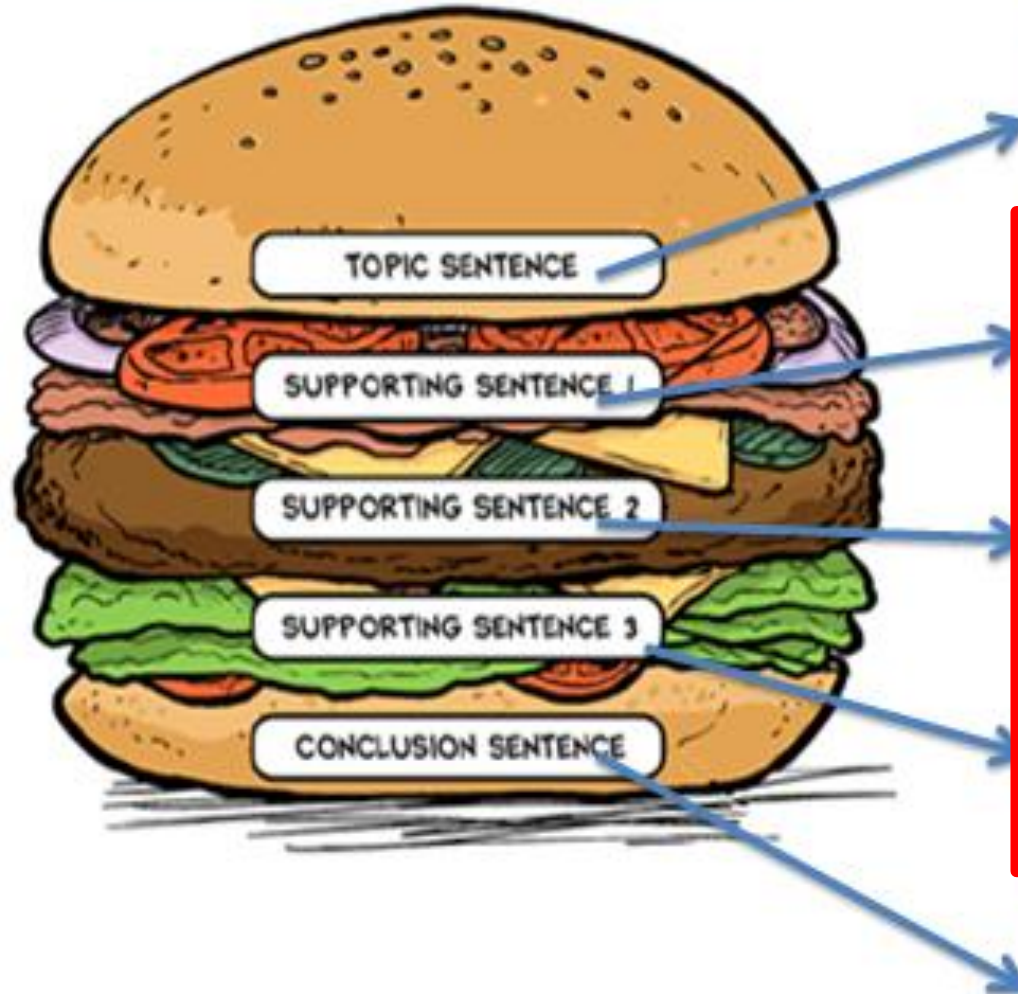
Lesson 10

Material prepared by Patricio Arnaldi T.

Example of a paragraph

The Internet has become really important for three main reasons. *First*, it enables people to access more information than ever before. *That is*, people can read books, newspapers, or magazines online and for free. *Second*, thanks to the Internet, people can communicate with others in every part of the world via social networking websites like Facebook, WhatsApp, WeChat, Twitter, Skype, Viber, Snapchat, LinkedIn, Reddit, etc. *Third*, the Internet is a perfect tool to study and get certificates from well-known top universities. *In other words*, now more than ever, anyone can do free online courses in a variety of subjects. *In short*, the Internet is, beyond doubt, an essential and valuable tool nowadays.

Hamburger paragraph



Parts of a Paragraph

Topic Sentence: This sentence tells the reader the main idea, or what the paragraph will be about.

Supporting Sentence One: This sentence gives specific details relating to the main idea.

Supporting Sentence Two: This sentence gives another specific detail relating to the main idea.

Supporting Sentence Three: This sentence gives more specific details relating to the main idea.

Concluding Sentence: This sentence refers to the topic sentence and sums up the main idea of the paragraph.

Today

Supporting Sentence

A supporting sentence explains, develops, or gives examples of the main idea in the topic sentence.

Functions of Supporting Sentences:

- Explain: Clarify the idea in more detail.
- Give examples: Show evidence from business situations.
- Provide data or facts: Use statistics, numbers, or results.
- Add reasons: Justify or support the topic sentence logically.

Explanation vs Reason

An **explanation** clarifies *how* or *in what way* something happens. It develops the topic sentence by describing a process, a situation, or the way something works.

Example:

Topic sentence: Good communication improves teamwork.

Explanation: When team members share information clearly, everyone understands their roles and tasks better.

Explanation vs Reason

- A **reason** tells *why* something is true or happens.
It gives a cause or justification that supports the main idea logically.

Example:

Topic sentence: Good communication improves teamwork.

Reason: Because clear communication prevents misunderstandings, teams can complete projects more efficiently.

Text 1

Topic sentence: Effective leadership is essential for company growth.

Leaders who communicate clearly inspire confidence and motivation. They also create a vision that employees can follow. When people understand the company's goals, they feel more committed to achieving them.

What type of support do the supporting sentences provide?

- a. Data or facts
- b. Examples
- c. Explanation
- d. Reasons

Text 2

Topic sentence: A company can improve its image through corporate social responsibility (CSR).

For example, when a business donates to local charities or supports environmental projects, customers view it more positively. Another example is when companies promote ethical labor practices, which increases consumer trust.

What type of support do the supporting sentences provide?

- a. Reasons
- b. Explanation
- c. Data or facts
- d. Examples

Text 3

Topic sentence: Employee satisfaction directly affects productivity levels.

According to a recent survey by Deloitte, 78% of employees who feel valued perform better at work. Furthermore, companies with high satisfaction rates reported 21% higher profitability last year.

What type of support do the supporting sentences provide?

- a. Explanation
- b. Data or facts
- c. Examples
- d. Reasons

Text 4

Topic sentence: Providing flexible working hours benefits both employees and companies.

When workers have control over their schedules, they can balance personal and professional responsibilities. As a result, they feel less stressed and more motivated, which leads to better performance.

What type of support do the supporting sentences provide?

- a. Reasons
- b. Explanation
- c. Data or facts
- d. Examples

A. Read each topic sentence and supporting idea, and add a second supporting idea.

1. Good language learners share a number of characteristics.

a. Successful language learners have perseverance.

b.

2. There are some important steps buyers should follow when purchasing a new car.

a. Research online the type of car that best suits your budget and general needs.

b.

3. Owning a dog requires some very important responsibilities.

a. Dogs require daily walks to maintain their health.

b.

4. There are a number of music styles that are popular with young people.

a. Hip-hop, also known as rap music, is a style that grew out of American cities in the 1970s.

b.

B. Read the topic sentences and supporting ideas below, and add supporting details in the form of an example or explanation.

1. First year university students face a number of challenges in adapting to university life.

a. They have to learn to live independently for the first time. This is due to the fact that up until entering college, most students have lived with their parents and have had all important decisions made for them.

b. They have to develop effective time management skills.

.....

2. Social inequality is a growing problem with many arguing there is an urgent need to increase taxes on the wealthiest people in society.

a. One argument for imposing higher taxes on the rich is that many of them have more money than they need. For example, the world's wealthiest person is worth approximately \$200 billion, which is equal to the combined wealth of the poorest 30 per cent of the American population.

b. Secondly, money raised by increased taxes can be used to improve society.

.....

C. Use the prompts below to write a topic sentence, a supporting idea, and supporting details.

Example: **Topic:** sport **Supporting idea:** team sports **Details:** football and basketball

Sports can be divided into a number of categories. One popular category is teams sports in which players cooperate together in order to score. For instance, football and basketball are two widely played sports in which players use a round ball to score goals and points respectively.

1. **Topic:** benefits of educating girls **Supporting idea:** better economy
Details: more human resources

.....

.....

.....

2. **Topic:** advantages of working from home **Supporting idea:** less stress
Details: flexible schedule, casual clothing, and no commuting

.....

.....

.....

3. **Topic:** banning zoos

Supporting idea: insufficient space

Details: large animals travel over 40 kilometres a day

.....

.....

.....

4. **Topic:** effects of regular exercise

Supporting idea: improved appearance

Details: weight loss, muscle tone and posture

.....

.....

.....

5. **Topic:** difference between economy and business class flights

Supporting idea: level of comfort

Details: legroom and reclining

.....

.....

.....

D. Choose one of the topic sentences above and create an outline for the body paragraph using keywords and phrases.

Topic sentence:

Supporting idea 1:

Details:

.....

Supporting idea 2:

Details:

.....

E. Now, swap paragraphs with a classmate and use the paragraph writing checklist below to give each other feedback.

Checklist	Yes/No
There is a clear topic sentence.	
There are at least two or three supporting ideas.	
Each supporting idea is followed by an example or explanation.	
Each supporting idea directly links to the topic sentence and conclusion.	
The concluding sentence clearly links back to the topic sentence.	
Ideas are generally well organized and easy to follow.	
Punctuation is correct, especially commas.	
Spelling has been checked.	
Capital letters have been used correctly.	